

Michael Allen

mcallen71398@gmail.com | (831) 521-6311 | [Linkedin](#) | [Github](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Security-cleared intelligence analyst transitioning into DevOps with hands-on experience designing and operating Linux-based infrastructure, containerization platforms, and declarative code. Strong background in high-availability systems, version control, and application monitoring, with proven ability to learn new technologies quickly and secure sensitive data. Experienced trainer and team lead with demonstrated administrative and cross-agency coordination skills.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Architect and Administrator (Personal Lab) *(Jan 2024 - Present)*

Self-employed / Homelab

- Migrated 20 containerized applications from a single host docker system to High Availability Kubernetes, using FluxCD and kustomize for consistent, declarative deployments across three servers, increasing uptime by 25%.
- Designed and administered a 12-device home network with custom firewall rules, ingress routing, and remote access via Tailscale for five users, drastically reducing attack surface while maintaining easy accessibility.
- Implemented Prometheus monitoring with Grafana dashboards to maintain high availability and visibility for user-facing services, decreasing mean time to repair by nearly 2 hours.
- Utilized Terraform to provision Backblaze B2 storage for etcd backups, and implemented monthly backup testing and recovery lifecycle to continuously validate system restoration capabilities and maintain data integrity.

Administrative Clerk *(Oct 2025 - Present)*

U.S. Air Force / Department of Defense / National Security Agency

- Maintained personnel accountability across 4 divisions covering approximately 300 personnel, conducting reviews of personnel records every 30 days, ensuring 100% accuracy in records for emergency response.
- Streamlined tracking for inbound and outbound personnel movements via automation, mitigating human error and lowering the weekly maintenance workload for a 3-person administrative team by 20%.

Team Lead and Trainer *(Jun 2023 - Oct 2025)*

U.S. Air Force / Department of Defense / National Security Agency

- Managed a team of 15 analysts and coordinated operations with 3 partner agencies to align efforts for a national priority mission, resulting in the arrest of multiple criminal targets.
- Delivered more than 200 hours of hand-on training and professional development, supporting the rapid qualification of 14 analysts, completing on-the-job training an average of 45 days early.

Language Analyst (Signals Intelligence) *(Jan 2021 - Jun 2023)*

U.S. Air Force / Department of Defense / National Security Agency

- Conducted target research and analysis across 6 global communications networks, identifying key communications and essential intelligence elements.
- Disseminated signals intelligence reports to over 20 customers, ensuring accurate and timely delivery of intelligence to stakeholders, supporting the fulfillment of 6 Information Needs.

Firestop Technician / Life Safety Installer *(Apr 2020 - Dec 2020)*

Prevent Fire Safety

- Installed STI Firestop systems in healthcare environments to ensure through-penetrations in fire-rated barriers met building codes and NFPA standards.
- Performed above-ceiling inspections and applied intumescent materials to prevent the spread of fire, smoke, and toxic gases across critical partitions.

EDUCATION

Defense Language Institute

B.A. in Linguistics (Spanish Emphasis) (2025)

Mississippi College

Coursework toward B.S. in Biology (Pre-Med track) (2020)

SKILLS

Technical: Debian, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, NixOS, Windows, QEMU/KVM, Docker, Podman, Kubernetes (K3S), FluxCD, Terraform, Helm, Git, Bash, Python, DNS configuration, Firewall management, VPNs, Traefik, Prometheus, Grafana, GitHub Actions, Longhorn, Cloud Native PostgreSQL, Tailscale, MS Office Suite, DX, GRAPEVINE, RAD, CYBERTRANS

Leadership: Team leadership and supervision, Training and professional development, Cross-agency coordination, Personnel accountability and administration, Technical documentation, Project coordination, Written and verbal communication, Public speaking

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENSES

CompTIA Security+ — CompTIA (2026)